Two-level root table: a TLB-resident filter in front of 16-byte exact slots for the n = 83 K600 one-target index calculus

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Status (2026-10-15): diagnosis done (diagnostic), fix implemented and checked for exactness, protocol frozen, Tier 1 run started; no result yet. The frozen protocol and schedule were committed before any Tier 1 timing. The run is the push-triggered workflow `.github/workflows/n83-table-filter.yml` on branch `claude/n83-table-filter` (run 38829449594, commit 1bf514cb3). Its receipt, result, result figure and the refreshed PDF are owed after the run. Nothing on this page is a Tier 1 measurement yet.

Question

The current n = 83 a = 1 K600 one-target probe path is the probe-pipeline producer (`claude/n83-probe-pipeline` @ ddbb86a9c: lift_scan + Feistel order + prefetched root-table probes; run 38822490448 in flight). Its profile put the root-table lookup into the ~4 GiB table at 59% of a 472 ns probe at 22 instructions per probe; prefetch cut it from 276 to 145 ns in a VM diagnostic, and a deeper pipeline did not help. About one probe in 1.7 million hits the table.

What limits the remaining lookup, and does a root-table layout built for that limit lower the one-target online time on new public points, with probes, relation and scalar unchanged? Under AGENTS.md's success criterion a verified, measured improvement over the current baseline is a success and becomes the new baseline.

1. Diagnosis (diagnostic)

All numbers in this section come from the cloud-agent VM, a shared 4-vCPU Intel Xeon guest. They chose the design; they are not evidence of a speedup. Raw files: `smoke/profile/`; table: `analysis/profile_local.json` (`analysis/make_profile_table.py`).

Layout (from the source). `RootTable128` is open addressing with linear probing over `(u128, u64)` slots, which pad to 32 bytes; its capacity is `(2*2*#states).next_power_of_two()` = 2^27 slots, 4 GiB, for 29,878,182 keys (load 0.22). A probe hashes the 83-bit canonical key multiplicatively to its home slot and reads one or two slots. Each index state makes about 332 probes; all but about one in 1.7 million miss.

Instrument. The profiler `ic_table_profile_r770` (`make_profile_source.py`, a derived copy of the producer, never a timed arm) keeps the probe-pipeline profiler's variants and adds, from the same 4 GiB table's entries, a 16-byte-slot copy and a 32 MiB blocked filter. It walks the first 400 states of target w11's Feistel order (132,800 probes), 7 rounds in rotated order, median per variant. In-situ variants are cumulative over the key computation (203 ns/probe); lookup-only loops run over the same keys in batches of one state's keys. Each was run with 2 MiB pages (THP via `glibc.malloc.hugetlb=1`, the runner's default) and with 4 KiB pages.

lookup	in situ, THP (ns/probe)	in situ, 4 KiB	lookup only, no prefetch / prefetched (THP)
4 GiB, 32-byte slots, combined loop (pC)	276	423	65 / 79
4 GiB, 32-byte slots, probe pipeline (pP)	**142**	281	

lookup	in situ, THP (ns/probe)	in situ, 4 KiB	lookup only, no prefetch / prefetched (THP)
2 GiB, 16-byte slots, same pipeline	138	264	58 / 67
32 MiB filter + 16-byte slots, two-level loop	**13**	26	44 / 21 (filter)

Reading. (i) Prefetching does not overlap lookups into the 2 to 4 GiB tables: in a lookup-only loop the prefetched version is no faster than the plain one (79 against 65 ns), and in situ about 140 ns per probe remain even though about 200 ns of key computation separate each prefetch from its use. (ii) Halving the slot to 16 bytes changes almost nothing (142 to 138 ns). So bytes per slot and cache-line traffic are not the limit. (iii) 4 KiB pages double the big tables' cost, while the 32 MiB filter's prefetched lookups cost 21 ns under either page size, and its prefetches do overlap (44 to 21 ns). The limit is address translation for a working set far beyond TLB reach: page walks whose own page-table entries are not cached, with few walks in flight, which a software prefetch cannot hide. This matches the `ic-probe-latency-20261015` pointer chase on the runner (4 GiB: 140 ns with THP against 200 ns at 4 KiB; 2 MiB buffer: 15 ns) and the earlier hypothesis. It is a diagnosis from one VM; the runner's AMD EPYC may differ in degree, and the run's last step records the same variants there.

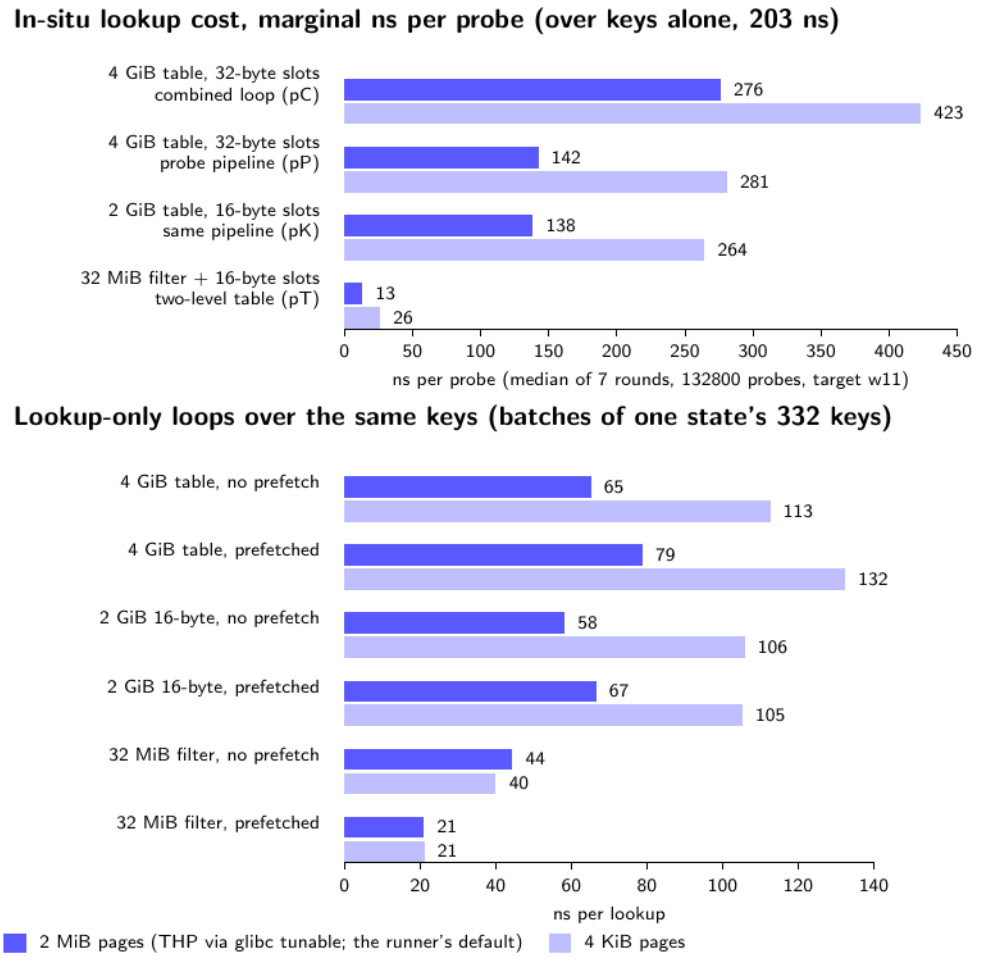


Figure 1: Lookup diagnosis (diagnostic)

So the fix is (b), a small first level that is TLB-resident and rejects most misses, with (a), the 16-byte slot, for the rare survivors (it halves the table's memory and its zero-fill, not the probe's latency).

2. The two-level root table

`make_online_source.py` derives the producer in two steps:

1. `make_probepipe_source.py` is `claude/n83-probe-pipeline`'s `make_online_source.py` @ ddbb86a9c, verbatim (with the combined derivation it imports). Its output must hash to the probe-pipeline protocol's frozen producer digest (`840b1648...`), so the baseline text is exactly that producer.
2. Counted, exact replacements add `KIC_ROOT_TABLE`, read once per process when the index is built:
   - `base` (default): `RootTable128`, built and probed exactly as before. The baseline arm runs `scan_state128_pipelined`, unchanged.
   - `compact`: `CompactRootTable128`. One 128-bit word per slot: bits 0..83 the whole key, bits 83..127 the four `pack` fields (left, right, relative shift, stored shift) in 11 bits each, bit 127 occupied. Same capacity rule (2^27 slots, now 2 GiB), the same multiplicative hash and the same linear-probe sequence, filled by the same inserts in the same order. A key wider than 83 bits or a field of 2^11 or more panics on insert; at n = 83, K = 600 the fields are below 600 and 83.
   - `filter`: the compact table plus `RootFilter128`, a register-blocked Bloom filter: 2^22 words of 64 bits (32 MiB, 16 huge pages; 2^28 bits, 9 bits per key). A key's 64-bit hash picks the word with its top 22 bits and sets five bits from its low five 6-bit groups. It is built after the table from the table's keys, timed separately in setup (`root_filter_build_ms`). The predicted false-positive rate is 2.3% (Poisson model); the local smoke saw 2.45% of probes pass falsely over 64 primary-panel targets.
   - `filter_plant`: the planted positive control (below).

   With a new layout the target scan is `scan_state128_filtered` (`KIC_PROBE_PIPELINE=prefetch`, lift_scan and the Feistel order only): the probe pipeline's root batch and keys in the same order (shift outer, stored root inner, solver partner order), each key followed by a prefetch of its filter word; then, in probe order, the filter test, prefetching each survivor's home slot; then the survivors, in probe order, get the exact compact-table lookup, lift and relation check, with the probe counter set to the survivor's position in the state.

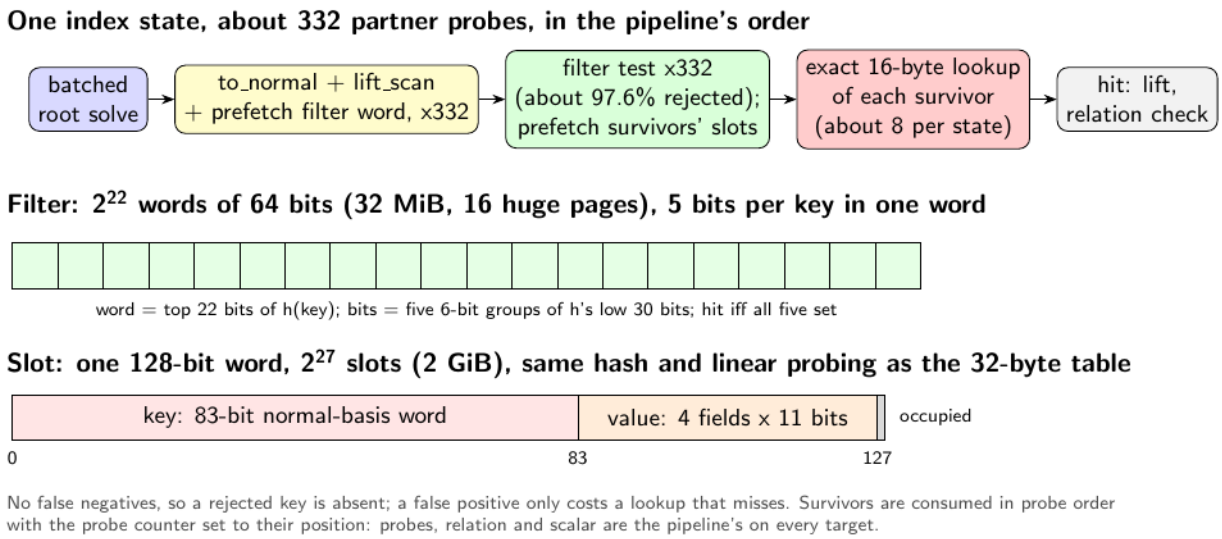


Figure 2: The two-level table and its scan loop

Exactness. The filter has no false negatives: every stored key was inserted, and insertion only sets bits. So a rejected key is absent from the table, and the base lookup would have returned nothing for it. A false positive only costs a compact lookup that misses. The compact table stores the same key → value map as the base table (same inserts, and the 128-bit word holds the full key and every value field exactly). Survivors are consumed in probe order, the counter at a hit equals the pipeline's (`first + position + 1`, and `first + keys` at the end of a state), and the first lifted relation returns. Therefore every target's probes, relation, intermediates and scalar are those of

the probe pipeline. The only extra work is the filter test and keys after the successful probe in the final state, which the clock charges. The rank stage is unchanged and needs the base table; the new layouts refuse to run without the verified cached factor-log table (every arm uses it).

Checks in the producer's tests (`cargo test --bins`, run again on the runner): the slot round-trips every field and refuses overflow; on a 9-orbit n = 83 base the compact table returns the base table's value for every stored key and agrees on 200,000 random keys; the filter has no false negatives (with 2^28, 2^14 and 2^16 bits); and on 24 planted four-point targets, with lift and full canonicalizers and both scan orders, every layout (including a 2^13-bit filter that passes most probes) gives the pipeline's exact relation and probe count, no rejected key is found in the table, and filter passes lie between table hits and probes.

Setup and memory. The compact table halves the root table (4 → 2 GiB) and its zero fill; the filter adds 32 MiB and one pass over the 2 GiB table. Locally (diagnostic) peak RSS fell from 5.81 to 3.70 GB, the index build from 74.9 to 65.4 s, and the filter build took 1.7 s inside it. The Tier 1 run reports setup, index build, filter build, peak RSS and the cold cost (setup + one target) for every arm.

Not combined with the state fold. `claude/n83-state-fold` (run 38819494806, in flight) halves the stored states and the table capacity to 2^26 slots. With the filter, the big table is touched by about 2.5% of probes, so the fold's capacity change no longer bears on the lookup; its setup saving is independent and is the next combination to try once both runs report.

3. Frozen Tier 1 design

Arm	Table	Filter	Panel	Role
`pP`	base (32 B slots, 4 GiB)	—	primary	baseline: the probe-pipeline producer
`pT`	filter + compact (16 B, 2 GiB)	32 MiB	primary	candidate
`pTaa`	filter + compact	32 MiB	primary	A/A control
`pX`	filter + compact + discarded lookups	32 MiB	primary	planted positive control
`pK`	compact only	—	primary	secondary: slot size alone
`pT29`	filter + compact	64 MiB	primary	secondary: filter size
`rT`	—	—	primary, every point	tuned rho rT770 (Fold/64/DP6), seed 860000 + point seed
`oP`, `oT`	base / filter	— / 32 MiB	Q0 + B's 16 fresh, 1 block	exactness against the archived Feistel identities; secondary

Every IC arm runs lift_scan, the Feistel order and the prefetch pipeline. The planted control `pX` looks up, in the compact table, every key the filter rejects (prefetched with its filter word) and discards the result: it re-adds the big-table access the filter removes, so `pX/pT` must exceed 1, and every such lookup must find nothing (`planted_rejected_found` = 0).

- **Primary panel.** 384 new public points (`inputs/primary_targets.json`, `make_targets.py`) from B's public hash-to-curve law with the new role `tablefilter-primary-v1`, seeds 0..383, checked disjoint from every earlier n = 83 panel of that law on main and the open branches: Q0 and B's fresh points (`eval`), the 384 scan-order held-out points (main), the 576 combined primary points (`claude/n83-combined`), the 384 probe-pipeline primary points (`claude/n83-probe-pipeline`) and the 16 state-fold cold points (`claude/n83-state-fold`), all regenerated. The section 23 panel has no n = 83 curve. No scalar is known for any of them.
- **One job, one pinned CPU.** Six primary slices of 64 points and one Q0 + fresh block, P1, P2, P3, O1, P4, P5, P6, each a seeded shuffle. Every slice holds one process per IC arm and one rho process per point. Each IC process does its setup once, then gives each target its own one-target online interval.

- **Primary statistic.** R_m = mean `pP` / mean `pT`, online time over all 384 points, bootstrap over points, 10,000 resamples.
- **Decision rule. Improvement** iff the 95% lower bound of R_m exceeds 1; regression iff its upper bound is below 1; otherwise not_separated. The verdict is **invalid** if an exactness gate fails, a decision arm's row is invalid, the A/A (`pT/pTaa` inside [0.97, 1.03]) or the planted control (`pX/pT` lower bound above 1) fails, or any of the 384 points lacks a valid row in `pP`, `pT`, `pTaa`, `pX` or `rT`.
- **Also reported.** R_g (paired geometric means); ns/probe and the filter's false-positive share per arm; the probe ratio (must be exactly 1); `pP/pK` and `pK/pT` (slot size against filter), `pT/pT29` (filter size); setup, index and filter build and peak RSS per arm, and the cold ratio (slice setup + target online); `S_rho` and cold `S_rho` for `pP` and `pT` and their delta; the tuned-rho gap on the same points; the slice bootstrap and per-slice ratios; the Q0 + fresh block.
- **Exactness gates.** Every process reports the requested layout and filter size, 29,878,182 keys in 2^27 slots, and `KIC_ROOT_BLOOM` off. On every primary point the six IC arms have identical probes and relation; one scalar across them and the tuned rho; every scalar replays as [d]G = Q in the pinned oracle; in every filter record, table hits $\leq$ filter passes $\leq$ probes; no record finds a rejected key. On Q0 + 16 fresh, both arms reproduce the archived Feistel probes and relations of run 38786433493, the archived scalars and Q0's validation sidecar.
- **Power, checked before freezing** (`power_check.py`, `analysis/power.json`). The probe-pipeline run had not reported, so the prior is the earlier one (the old held-out panel's Feistel times over the measured lift_scan ratio; per-point effect spread from the 16 lift_scan ratios; noise sigma 0.02 per target, 0.01 per process). For a minimal effect of interest of 1.03, power is 0.77 at 64 points, 0.92 at 128 and 1.00 at 384; the smallest size passing 0.80 after two Monte Carlo SEs is
  128. The panel is the design floor of 384, so that the slice bootstrap has six clusters.
- **Runtime estimate.** About 1.3 to 2.0 h including the build, with a 300-minute time guard. A last step runs the profiler on Q0 on the runner (`profile_diagnostic_*.json`), diagnostic only.

Local validation (cloud-agent VM; no timing claims)

See `smoke/README.md`.

Files

File	Role
`protocol.json`, `make_protocol.py`, `schedule.json`, `make_schedule.py`	frozen protocol, its builder, frozen run order
`make_online_source.py`, `make_probepipe_source.py`, `make_combined_source.py`, `online/`, `lift2/`	the two-level table producer (verbatim parent derivations, digest-checked, plus `KIC_ROOT_TABLE`); tuned rho; the two-limb canonicalizer crate
`make_profile_source.py`, `analysis/make_profile_table.py`, `analysis/profile_local.json`, `smoke/profile/`	the diagnostic profiler, the diagnosis table and its raw inputs
`restore.py`, `check_log_table.py`	restore and digest-check crypto 770f6a69 and every local source; re-verify B's factor-log table
`make_targets.py`, `inputs/primary_targets.json`	the new primary panel
`inputs/archived_identities.json`	archived probes, relations and scalars of Q0 and the 16 fresh points (from `claude/n83-combined`)
`power_check.py`, `inputs/power_prior.json`, `analysis/power.json`	power simulation, its prior, its result
`arm.py`, `panels.py`, `run_schedule.py` `verify_receipt.py`	one arm per pinned process; panels; the schedule runner gates, statistics, decision rule; `result.json`, `result_table.md`
`make_figures.py`, `figures/`	TikZ sources and renders of the diagnosis and the table diagram

Limits

- The diagnosis is from one Intel VM. The runner (an AMD EPYC in recent runs) has other TLB sizes and page-walk concurrency; the runner's profiler step records the same variants there, still as a diagnostic.
- Tier 1, instance-scoped: one runner, one pinned CPU, not host-isolated.
- The baseline `pP` is the probe-pipeline producer's loop compiled into the same binary as the candidate; this experiment does not re-run that experiment's binary.
- The filter size (32 MiB) and five hash bits were chosen from the Poisson model and the local diagnosis, before any Tier 1 timing; `pT29` is a reported secondary, not a tuning step.
- The tuned-rho gap is distance remaining, not a claim to beat rho.
- Next steps after this run: combine with the state fold (setup and table memory), then the next-largest probe component, the batched root solve (about 130 ns of a probe whose lookup would then cost about 15 ns).